



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES
July 22, 2025

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session in Council Chambers and was called to order at 6:30 p.m. by Mayor Daniel J. Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Christy Davis, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent: none.

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Clerk Andrea Muray, Chief Equity Officer John Willis, Police Chief Chris Simpson, and City Engineer Troy White.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to adopt the agenda.

Motion was made by Mayor Mahoney, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to amend the agenda by moving Item 9A to 5A, and Item 5A to 5B. Vote was done by voice with all in favor.

Motion was made by Mayor Mahoney, seconded Councilmember Wood to amend the agenda by adding Item 9A – Appointment of David Hammontree to the Board of Review. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

Vote was taken on the main motion as amended. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS:

A. Resolution honoring the life and service of Martin John Griffin

Recommendation: *Adopt a resolution paying homage to the contributions of Martin J. Griffin to the City of Jackson.*

Motion was made by Mayor Mahoney, seconded by Councilmember Wood, to adopt the resolution. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

B. Jackson Racial Equity Audit Results

Tom Christoff and John Willis provided Council with the Audit Results.

PUBLIC HEARINGS: none.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

Motion was made Councilmember Davis, seconded by Councilmember Wood to take a 10 minute recess. Vote was done by voice with all in favor.

Recess was taken from 7:41 p.m. until 7:52 p.m.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to return from recess. Vote was done by voice with all in favor.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

A. Minutes of the June 10, 2025, Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council

B. Water Relief Fund

Direct the Treasurer's Office to remove the option of donating a tax return to the Parks and Recreation Department and replace it with the option to donate to a newly created Water Relief Fund

C. Lansing Avenue Alley Vacation

Authorize the signing of petition for property located 1111 Lansing Avenue, receive the petition, and refer to staff.

D. City of Jackson, Michigan Financial Statements for the Eleven Months Ended May 31, 2025

E. Traffic Control Orders 2408-2412

Approve Traffic Control Orders 2408 through 2412 to restore on-street parking on the north side of Washington Avenue from West Avenue to First Street.

F. Traffic Control Order 2414

Approve Traffic Control Order 2414 to install "Autistic Child Area" signs on Burr Street between Columbus Street and Cooper Street.

G. Special Event Application: July Cruise-In and Concert

Approve a request from the Jackson Downtown Development Authority to host the July Cruise-In and Concert on July 25, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

H. Special Event Application: Mitchell Tenpenny Concert

Approve a request from the Michigan Theatre of Jackson to host the Mitchell Tenpenny Concert on August 10, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

I. Special Event Application: Jack-O-Lantern Paws Parade Fest 2nd Annual

Approve a request from the Jack-Son Signature, LLC to host the Jack-O-Lantern Paws Parade Fest 2nd Annual on October 4, 2025, at Horace Blackman Park in downtown Jackson.

J. Special Event Application: Alzheimer's Association Walk to End Alzheimer's Jackson

Approve a request from the Alzheimer's Disease & Related Disorders Association to host the Alzheimer's Association Walk to End Alzheimer's Jackson on October 11, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

K. Special Event Application: Central Michigan Team Hope Walk

Approve a request from the Huntington's Disease Society of America Upper Great Lakes Region to host the Central Michigan Team Hope Walk on October 11, 2025 in downtown Jackson.

L. Special Event Application: Big Miles for Little Smiles

Approve a request from the Big Brothers Big Sisters of Jackson County to host the Big Miles for Little Smiles on September 14, 2025, at Ella Sharp Park in Jackson.

M. Special Event Application: 2nd Annual Flat Iron District Block Party

Approve a request from The Welcome Home Organization to host the 2nd Annual Flat Iron District Block Party on August 9, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the consent calendar. Councilmember Forgrave requested Item 8B be removed for separate consideration. Councilmember Davis requested Item 8C be removed for separate consideration. Vote was taken on approval of the consent calendar (without Items B and C). Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

(Item 8B) Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to replace the option of donating to the Parks and Recreation Department with the option to donate to the Water Relief Fund.

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Wood to add the option to donate to the Water Relief Fund to the option to donate to the Parks and Recreation Department. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

(Item 8C) Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to authorize the signing of the petition for property located at 1111 Lansing Avenue, receive the petition, and refer to staff. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS: none.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. Appointment of David Hammontree to the Board of Review

Recommendation: *Appoint David Hammontree to the Board of Review as recommended by Mayor Daniel Mahoney.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to appoint David Hammontree to the Board of Review. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. First Amendment to the Health Care Savings Program Withdrawal and Asset Transfer Agreement

Recommendation: *Adoption of the resolution for the First Amendment to the Health Care Savings Program Withdrawal and Asset Transfer Agreement between City of Jackson, Michigan and Municipal Employees' Retirement System of Michigan (Division #301289 – IAFF)*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave, to adopt the resolution for the First Amendment to the Health Care Savings Program Withdrawal and Asset Transfer Agreement between City of Jackson, Michigan and Municipal Employees' Retirement System of Michigan (Division #301289 – IAFF). Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Contract award for the MLK Equality Trail Extension

Recommendation: *Approve the award of the contract for the MLK Equality Trail Extension on Mechanic Street from Detroit Street to Trail Street to Merlo Construction Company, Inc. of Milford, Michigan at a cost of \$298,052.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the award of the contract for the MLK Equality Trail Extension on Mechanic Street from Detroit Street to Trail Street to Merlo Construction Company, Inc. of Milford, Michigan at a cost of \$298,052.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Forgrave (6). Nays: Councilmember Davis (1). Motion carried.

D. Change Order 3 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Phase 1 Water Main Replacement, West Division

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order 3 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Phase 1 Water Main Replacement, West Division contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc. in the decreased amount of \$327,341.74 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve Change Order 3 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Phase 1 Water Main Replacement, West Division contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc. in the decreased amount of \$327,341.74 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document. Vote

– Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

E. Change Order 3 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Phase 1, East Division

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order 3 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Phase 1 Water Main Replacement, East Division contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc. in the decreased amount of \$498,149.56 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document*

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve Change Order 3 to the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Phase 1 Water Main Replacement, East Division contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc. in the decreased amount of \$498,149.56. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

F. 2023 HMA Patching Contract – Second and Final Renewal

Recommendation: *Approve the second and final renewal of the 2023 HMA Patching contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc. of Jackson, Michigan in the estimated amount of \$254,528.68 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents in accordance with the Purchasing Agent.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the second and final renewal of the 2023 HMA Patching contract with Bailey Excavating, Inc. of Jackson, Michigan in the estimated amount of \$254,528.68 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

G. As-needed tree trimming, tree removals, and stump grinding bid award

Recommendation: *Award the bid for as-needed tree trimming, tree removals, and stump grinding to Johnny's Tree Service Inc. for \$217,330.00 in fiscal year 25/26 and \$217,330.00 in fiscal year 26/27 resulting in a two-year contract.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to award the bid for as-needed tree trimming, tree removals, and stump grinding to Johnny's Tree Service Inc. for \$217,330.00 in fiscal year 25/26 and \$217,330.00 in fiscal year 26/27 resulting in a two-year contract. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

H. Personnel Policy Update Effective 6.1.2025

Recommendation: *Approval of the Personnel Policy Update Effective 6.1.2025*

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the Personnel Policy Update Effective 6.1.2025. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

I. Sensus SmartPoint MXU Radio Reading Device Purchase

Recommendation: *Approval of the purchase for 2,430 Sensus SmartPoint MXU Radio Reading Devices from ETNA Supply of Grand Rapids in the amount of \$398,520 and approval of the Resolution to amend the budget for Fiscal Year 2025/26 to fund the purchase.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to approve of the purchase for 2,430 Sensus SmartPoint MXU Radio Reading Devices from ETNA Supply of Grand Rapids in the amount of \$398,520 and approval of the resolution to amend the budget for Fiscal Year 2025/26 to fund the purchase. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

J. Sale of 110 W Michigan Ave

Recommendation: *Approve the sale of 110 W Michigan Ave to the Michigan Theatre of Jackson for a price of \$160,000 and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to sign all sale documents associated with the Property Transfer and to make minor modifications.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve the sale of 110 W Michigan Ave to the Michigan Theatre of Jackson for a price of \$160,000 and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to sign all sale documents associated with the Property Transfer and to make minor modifications. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

K. City of Jackson and Michigan Association of Public Employees (MAPE) CBA

Recommendation: *Approve the Collective Bargaining Agreement between the City of Jackson and Michigan Association of Public Employees (MAPE).*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the Collective Bargaining Agreement between the City of Jackson and

Michigan Association of Public Employees (MAPE).

Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER’S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, and Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave all offered comments.

MANAGER’S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene offered comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Vice Mayor Dancy and was seconded by Councilmember Forgrave. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 8:33 p.m.